

English Homework: Session 6

While / When · Reading Fluency · Vocabulary from Texts · Philosophical Discussion

Student: Ahmet (Gürkan)

Date: March 2026

Est. Time: 1.5 hours

Next Lesson: Sunday

Hi Ahmet,

What a session! You played Two Truths and a Lie brilliantly — and your menemen recipe was so detailed that I'm genuinely going to try it. You read two challenging texts fluently and tackled some of the deepest questions in philosophy. Let's sharpen the edges with this homework!

Part 1 GRAMMAR — WHILE / WHEN / AS · TIME CLAUSES (30 MINUTES)

In today's session, when describing your omelette, you said "Why they are cooking" — the correct word is while. This is a very common and important grammar point at your level. Let's master it!

Grammar Point 1: While vs When — the KEY difference

✗ Your sentence: "Why they are cooking, add the cheese."

✓ Correct: "While they are cooking, add the cheese."

WHILE = during a period of time (two actions happening at the same time)

→ While I was driving, it started to rain.

→ While the peppers are frying, chop the tomatoes.

WHEN = at the moment / point in time that something happens

→ When the oil is hot, add the eggs.

→ When I graduated, I joined KGM directly.

📌 Quick rule: While = at the same time | When = at that moment

▷ Write two sentences about cooking or your work — one using WHILE and one using WHEN:

1. While:

2. When:

▷ Write the rule in your own words:

Grammar Point 2: As — a third time connector

AS is used when two actions develop or change together — it is similar to while but often shows cause or progression.

✓ As the oil heats up, it starts to smoke.

✓ As Turkey's road network grows, maintenance becomes more important.

✓ As I gained more experience, I became more confident.

📌 As = while + because / as time progresses

You can often replace as with as time went on or as [something] develops.

▷ **Write one sentence using AS about how something in your field has changed over time:**

Grammar Point 3: Error Correction — spot the mistakes

The paragraph below contains 5 errors with while / when / as and time expressions. Find them and write the corrected version underneath.

"Why I was working at KGM, I realised that data collection was very difficult. When I retired, I am thinking about starting my own company. As more I learned about pavement management, more I understood how big the problem was. I founded Geopave when I was working at KGM for 30 years. While the project ended, we presented the results to the committee."

▷ **Your corrected version:**

Part 2 READING FLUENCY & VOCABULARY (20 MINUTES)

You read two texts beautifully today — olive oil and machine learning. Below are the vocabulary words from both texts. Study them, then complete the challenge.

Section A — The Golden Elixir: Olive Oil Vocabulary

#	Word / Phrase	Example from text	Synonyms / Notes
1	Prized (adj)	A prized culinary treasure.	Highly valued, treasured, coveted
2	To cultivate (v)	Greeks cultivated olive trees on a large scale.	To grow, to farm, to develop
3	Maturity (n)	Olives are harvested at optimal maturity.	Ripeness, full development
4	Cold pressing (n)	Extra virgin oil is obtained through cold pressing.	Extraction without heat or chemicals
5	To preserve (v)	This method preserves the oil's natural nutrients.	To keep, to protect, to maintain
6	Ceremonial (adj)	Olive oil had deep ceremonial significance.	Ritual, religious, symbolic
7	Coveted (adj)	Premium olive oil is a coveted item.	Greatly desired, sought-after
8	Versatile (adj)	The most versatile substance ever produced.	Multifaceted, adaptable, multi-use

Section B — Machine Learning Vocabulary

#	Word / Phrase	Example from text	Synonyms / Notes
1	Algorithm (n)	ML relies on algorithms that adjust themselves.	Procedure, method, system
2	To classify (v)	It learns to classify spam emails.	To sort, to categorise, to identify
3	Intervention (n)	Decisions with minimal human intervention.	Involvement, interference, input
4	Remarkable (adj)	It classifies with remarkable accuracy.	Extraordinary, impressive, notable
5	Rigid (adj)	Instead of following rigid rules.	Strict, fixed, inflexible
6	To predict (v)	A model can make predictions on unseen data.	To forecast, to anticipate, to project

★ Vocabulary Challenge

Choose 4 words from the tables above (at least 2 from each section). Write one sentence for each, connected to your work, your cooking, or your daily life in Ankara.

1. Word: Sentence:

2. Word: Sentence:

3. Word: Sentence:

4. Word: Sentence:

Part 3 WRITING TASK — THE BIG QUESTIONS (25 MINUTES)

In today's session, your teacher gave you three genuinely philosophical questions to think about. You gave wonderful spoken answers — now let's put those ideas into writing. Write 4–5 sentences for each question. Try to use vocabulary from Part 2.

Useful Phrase Starters:

In my opinion... / From my experience... / I would argue that...
It seems to me that... / On reflection... / I have always believed...
This reminds me of... / As I see it... / Without doubt...
The more I think about it, the more I believe that...

Question 1: "Is language merely a tool for communication, or does it shape our consciousness?"

(Hint: Think about how thinking in Turkish feels different from speaking in English. Does the language you use change how you think or feel?)

Question 2: "The more you know, the more you know you don't know. Is intellectual humility a sign of wisdom or of weakness?"

(Hint: You mentioned İlber Ortaylı as an example of a great intellectual. What made him special? Do you see this quality in yourself?)

Question 3: "To lose your mother tongue is to lose part of yourself." Do you agree?

(Hint: You are learning English while keeping Turkish. Does speaking English change anything about how you feel or who you are?)

Bonus PRONUNCIATION — WORDS FROM TODAY'S TEXTS (10 MINUTES)

These words came up in the reading today. Some of them tripped you up — let's practise them! Read each word aloud 5 times, paying attention to the stressed syllable (shown in CAPITALS).

Word	Pronunciation guide	Stress pattern	Use in a sentence
dietitians	<i>die-uh-TI-shuns</i>	die-uh-TI-shuns	Dietitians recommend olive oil.
significance	<i>sig-NIF-i-kance</i>	sig-NIF-i-cance	The oil has cultural significance.
consciousness	<i>CON-shus-ness</i>	CON-shus-ness	Language shapes consciousness.
explicitly	<i>ex-PLIS-it-lee</i>	ex-PLIS-it-ly	The rules were explicitly stated.
ceremonial	<i>ser-uh-MOH-nee-ul</i>	ser-uh-MO-nee-ul	It was used for ceremonial purposes.
humility	<i>hyoo-MIL-i-tee</i>	hyoo-MIL-i-ty	He showed great intellectual humility.
versatile	<i>VER-suh-tile</i>	VER-suh-tile	It is the most versatile ingredient.

★ Mini Challenge

Choose 3 of the pronunciation words above and write one sentence each. Try to use a while / when / as clause in at least one of them.

1. Word: Sentence:

2. Word: Sentence:

3. Word: Sentence:

Quick Reference WHILE / WHEN / AS — SUMMARY

Word	Use	Example	Key tip
While	Two actions happening simultaneously	<i>While the oil heats, chop the pepper.</i>	= at the same time
When	At the moment/point something happens	<i>When the oil is hot, add the eggs.</i>	= at that point
As	Two actions develop or progress together	<i>As I learned more, I doubted more.</i>	= while + because

Great work today, Ahmet — keep that momentum going. Your menemen recipe alone deserves an A+!